Appendix 10

Address to the cadets – IMA passing-out parade: 12 June 2010

Lt Gen R.S. Sujlana, commandant, Indian Military Academy, parents, distinguished guests and gentleman cadets on parade.

It is indeed a great honour to review the passing out parade of the 126th Regular, 15TES, 109TGC, 18UES and 24 SCO courses of IMA. Your parade has been of an exceptionally high order and I wish to compliment each one of you and the directing staff for a fine display of a parade conducted with clinical military precision. It reflects the high level of training and professionalism achieved at the academy, which I am sure is precursor to a rewarding military career for all of you …

For me, gentlemen, 'India' is a civilizational concept … India empowered is the essence of this dream. To bear arms in the defence of one's country is a rare honour. However, the task of a military leader is, by no means, an easy one. It demands physical and moral courage, professional competence, physical fitness and leadership qualities of the highest order.

An India empowered can no longer be transgressed and trespassed. Our strength is reflected by a growing economy and a powerful military machine which is professional and modern.

We are amidst discernable and distinct changes which are shaping every sphere of life in general and the profession of arms in particular. The armed forces are no longer insulated from the socioeconomic-technological-internal security and geostrategic changes taking place, and are increasingly being impacted by the manifestation of these changes as we carry out our role and responsibility.

The nature of threat encompasses the entire spectrum of war fighting and includes … the entire gamut of socioeconomic challenges, which have resulted in a greater threat of terrorism,